hours, so she assumed they were still at the factories.

The guard checked her pass, and then she climbed the concrete stairs to the third floor, where she knew Nadiya had been living with the other women since arriving by cargo train months earlier. She reached the top floor and found an eerie silence in the corridor. She passed the bathrooms on her left, and farther along on her right, the door opened to a large room with bunk beds. She stepped inside.

Something was wrong. Not a single picture on the wall, no curtains on the windows, no pillows or sheets on the iron bunk beds. Her footsteps echoed off the empty walls. Where were the eighteen women who'd been living here? And what had happened to Nadiya's things? A small knot of panic began to form in Rose's chest. She looked out the window. The sun outside was blinding, filling her with a sharp fear. Perhaps there was a reason, she told herself, trembling. In desperation, she hurried to find the guard.

"The top floor is empty. What happened to the women living there?"

"They were sent away this morning," the guard said.

"Sent where?"

He shrugged. "I don't know. I was only told to clear everything out so there would be no trace of them."

No trace. She swallowed. "Were they sent by train?"

He shook his head. "Two trucks pulled up before dawn. They loaded the women and all the items they were allowed to carry in the back of those trucks."

"But you don't know where they went?"

"I don't make it my business to ask questions, especially when Kriminalinspektor Reinhardt gives the orders."

She went still. "Herr Reinhardt sent them away?"

"He came here to oversee the loading of the trucks."

A crushing weight pressed on Rose's chest, stealing her breath. Had Reinhardt betrayed her, shattering their fragile pact before it had begun?

"Thank you."

She turned away from the guard and the barracks. How had she not anticipated his betrayal? He was a Gestapo officer—what did honor mean to him? She felt the ring in her pocket where she'd carried it ever since his proposal. Rose had done what he'd asked, lying to her sister and André.